

Insights & Analysis

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Self-Assessment Project

Question 4 – Insights & Analysis

1. Identify the top 3 revenue-generating categories.

This insight shows that technology generated the highest amount of revenue, bringing in 1,397,550.00, followed by the clothing category at 214,557 and shoes at 158,142. From this, we can clearly see that customers mostly value technology products such as phones and laptops compared to fashion items.

Breakdown of insight:

- Higher unit prices: Technology products generally have higher prices per item. So, even if fewer units are sold, the revenue contribution per transaction is much larger.
- Urban lifestyle and tech demand: Istanbul is a fast-growing urban and business center, increasingly dependent on digital devices for work, education, and entertainment.
- Seasonal or promotional effects: Stores may have benefited from promotional campaigns that boosted sales over time.
- Customer demographic: The dataset includes a high proportion of younger or working-age customers which are groups that typically spend more on technology than on fashion.
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2. Identify the most valuable age group (highest total spend).

The customer age group that brings in the highest amount of revenue is 31–40. This age group is often stable in employment, indicating that mid-career adults are the most valuable customer segment for retail sales in Istanbul's shopping malls. This could be influenced by a tech-savvy lifestyle and family-driven spending. Many customers in this age group may also be supporting households, leading to purchases across multiple product categories.

3. Identify the most commonly used payment method.

The analysis shows that credit cards are the most frequently used payment method among customers. This suggests a strong preference for cashless and convenient transactions in Istanbul's retail environment.

Breakdown of the insight:

- Widespread access to banking services: There is growing financial inclusion and the popularity of digital banking.
- Convenience and rewards: Credit cards often offer benefits such as cashback, reward points, or installment payment options, making them an attractive choice compared to cash or debit cards.
- Consumer confidence and security: Shoppers may see credit card payments as safer and more trackable, especially for higher-value purchases like electronics and fashion.

4. Summarize any trends over time: e.g., which months have higher sales, or which malls perform best.

Monthly Revenue Trends for 2023 and 2024:

- Revenue peaks in February for both years, suggesting strong sales at the start of the year, possibly due to promotions, seasonal shopping, or post-holiday purchases (this could also include back-to-school shopping).
- June and August (summer months in Istanbul) tend to have lower revenue, especially in June, indicating slower shopping activity during that period.

Overall, this shows that customers do not spend consistently and that sales are influenced by seasonal trends.

Shopping Mall Performance:

- Metrocity leads in total revenue, followed by Forum Istanbul and Cevahir AVM. These malls likely attract more shoppers due to location, brand variety, and foot traffic.
- Smaller malls like Kanyon and Zorlu Center have lower revenue, which could be due to fewer stores, smaller size, or lower customer flow.

To maximize revenue, businesses should focus on promotions during slower summer months, prioritize inventory and marketing for high-performing malls, and tailor products and engagement strategies to the key 31–40 age group. Underperforming malls could benefit from introducing popular brands, events, or improved customer experiences to attract more shoppers.